critically reflects on German division as well as America's role as the self-appointed guarantor of global democracy during the years following World War II and the civil rights movement. Freed's work in each respective country's border zones produced images of mutual recognition.

Later other artists, writers, and activists similarly routed their own travels and cultural productions through the geopolitical crossroads of divided Berlin, pivoting their work between the United States and the two Germanys. In 1966 African American activist Angela Davis crossed the boundary of the Wall into East Berlin as a philosophy graduate student in West Germany on a trip with classmates. She opted to spend most of her time in East Berlin, to see family friends and experience the socialist workers' holiday May Day. The Wall was a well-established and embedded structure at that time. Davis later channeled her experiences on both sides of the border toward becoming a leading voice contesting the walls of the U.S. prison system. Her own best-selling 1974 autobiography features scenes that take place on both sides of Germany's divide, for her purpose of critically engaging Western practices of repression and state violence while downplaying and reinterpreting the stereotypical cultural intrigue of crossing through the Wall.

During the late 1960s through the mid-1980s, Japanese American sculptor Shinkichi Tajiri taught as an expatriate college art professor in West Berlin and extensively documented the Wall during its process of systematic structural revamping and aesthetic makeover. As Tajiri stalked the edges of the American sector and allied sectors of walled-in West Berlin, his resulting photographic survey brought him closer to his family's history of internment during World War II and his experience as a U.S. Army veteran confronting anti-Japanese racial hostilities. His extended project, *The Wall Die Mauer Le Mur* (1971), was made to represent the Wall as an architectural symbol of a divided world and the partitions suggestive of the history of the United States.

In 1984, poet Audre Lorde came to West Berlin with questions about U.S. geopolitics in an era of reaccelerated Cold War tensions and antagonisms as well as growing frustration with U.S. military incursions abroad and social divides at home. Lorde, who identified as a "black lesbian feminist warrior poet," among other intersectional distinctions, established divided Berlin as a place of habitual return, as she began building on previously uncharted diasporic solidarities and creating enduring forms of